

VICEROYS OF INDIA

Canning to Mountbatten (1856–1948)

Continued from Part 1: Governor General & Viceroy of India | For SSC CGL, CHSL, UP Police
Constable & other exams

- Headings & Definitions ● Explanations ● Highlighter = Key Facts 🎯 Exam Tip ✗ Common Mistake
🧠 Memory Trick

StudyPlanner



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LORD CANNING (1856–1862)

The **Revolt of 1857** — also called the "First War of Independence" by V. D. Savarkar — broke out during Canning's tenure.

- As a result of the revolt, the **East India Company's rule was abolished**.
- The **Government of India Act, 1858** was passed, transferring power directly to the British Crown.
- Canning served as **Governor General from 1856–1858**, and then became the **first Viceroy of India (1858–1862)** under this new Act.



Fig 1: 1857 Revolt → Canning Becomes Viceroy

Revolt of 1857 ("1st War of Independence")

East India Company abolished

Govt of India Act, 1858

Canning: 1st Viceroy

Lord Lawrence (after Canning & Elgin)

Elgin succeeded Canning but is **not exam-important**. Lawrence's tenure is also **not exam-important**; the **Bhutan War** took place during his time.

Exam Tip

One person, two titles: Canning was both the **last Governor General (1856-58)** and the **first Viceroy (1858-62)** of India!

Common Mistake

Don't assume Canning became Viceroy the moment the Revolt started in 1857 — the title changed only after the **Government of India Act, 1858** was passed.

Memory Trick

Chain it: "**1857 Revolt** → **1858 Act** → **Canning Crowned Viceroy**" — the Revolt causes the Act, and the Act causes the title change.

 Why did Company Rule end? (tap to expand) ▼

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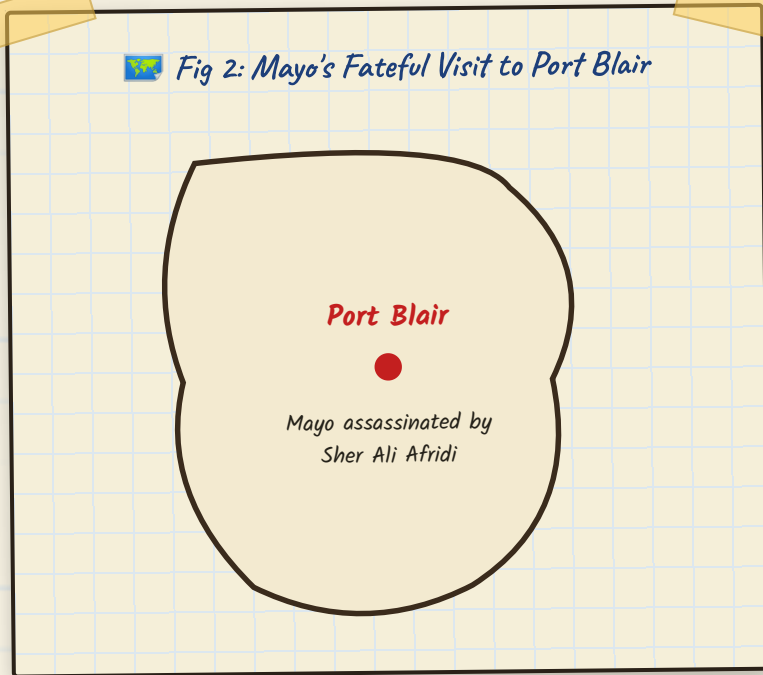
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LORD MAYO

- The *Statistical Survey of India* was created during his time.
- The *Census of 1872* took place during his tenure — it was *incomplete and unsynchronized* (not conducted uniformly across all of India).
- Mayo visited *Port Blair* (Andaman) to inspect the conditions of prisoners there.
- He was *assassinated at Port Blair* by Sher Ali Afridi, a Pathan convict.

 Fig 2: Mayo's Fateful Visit to Port Blair



Sad but exam-important

Mayo went to Port Blair to check on prisoners' conditions — and was killed there while doing so.

LORD LYTTON (1876-1880)

Considered *one of the worst Viceroy of India* — he treated Indians as subordinates.

- *Vernacular Press Act, 1878* — local-language newspapers needed British government permission before publishing anything.
- *Arms Act, 1878* — only Indians needed a license to keep arms (Europeans were exempt).
- *First Delhi Durbar, 1877* — organized for the coronation of *Queen Victoria*, held despite a severe ongoing famine.
- *Second Afghan War* took place during his tenure.

Delhi Durbar	Year	Viceroy	Occasion
1st	1877	Lytton	Queen Victoria's coronation
2nd	1903	—	—
3rd	1911	—	—



Quick Fact

Amrit Bazar Patrika (publisher **Shishir Kumar Ghosh**) converted overnight into an English-language paper — to escape the Vernacular Press Act!



Exam Tip

Lytton = **Press + Arms + Durbar + Afghan War** — four things to remember for exams.



Common Mistake

Don't confuse the **Vernacular Press Act** (1878, targets local-language press) with the **Arms Act** (1878, targets weapon licensing) — same year, same Viceroy, different targets!



Memory Trick

A famine was raging, yet Lytton still held a lavish Delhi Durbar in 1877 — remember him as the Viceroy who put British pomp above Indian suffering.

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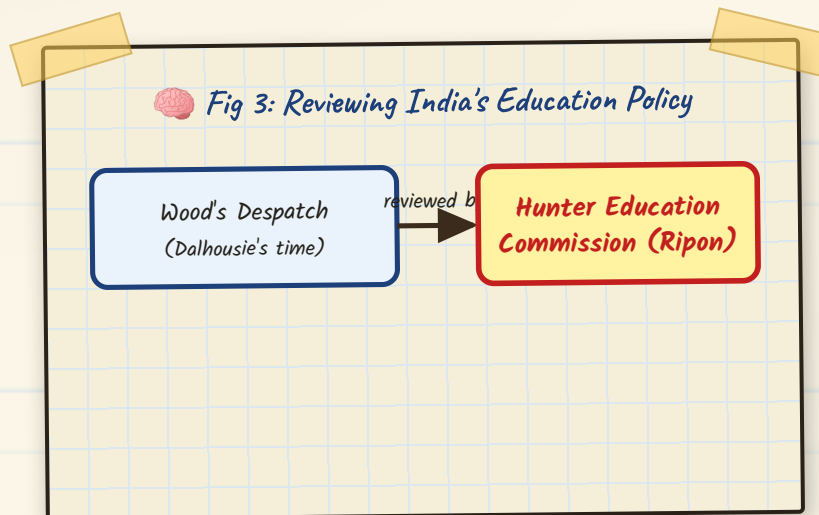
LORD RIPON (1880-1884)

Known for cleaning up Lytton's controversial policies and doing good work for Indians.

- Repealed the Vernacular Press Act.
- Repealed the Arms Act.

- **First Factory Act, 1881** — improved conditions for factory workers, including children and women (limited working hours, fixed wages).
- **Hunter Education Commission** — an education commission formed to review the education system (a different commission from the later one on the Jallianwala Bagh massacre).
- **Ilbert Bill controversy, 1883** — drafted by **C.P. Ilbert**; would have allowed **Indian judges to try Europeans** (previously, only European judges could try Europeans). Faced heavy British protest in both India and Britain and had to be **withdrawn**.

📖 Flashback — Wood's Despatch, Dalhousie's time (tap to expand) ▼



LORD DUFFERIN

- The **Indian National Congress** was formed during his tenure.
- Dufferin famously called the Congress a "factory of sedition."

🎯 Exam Tip

Ripon undid Lytton's damage: **Vernacular Press Act repealed + Arms Act repealed + Factory Act (1881) + Hunter Education Commission** — all pro-Indian moves!

❌ Common Mistake

Don't confuse the **Ilbert Bill** (1883, judicial equality attempt — withdrawn) with Ripon's **successful** repeal of the Vernacular Press Act — one bill failed due to British protest, the other reform succeeded.

🧠 Memory Trick

Ripon = "good," Lytton = "bad" — both carried the title "Lord," but only Ripon's actions actually earned Indians' respect.

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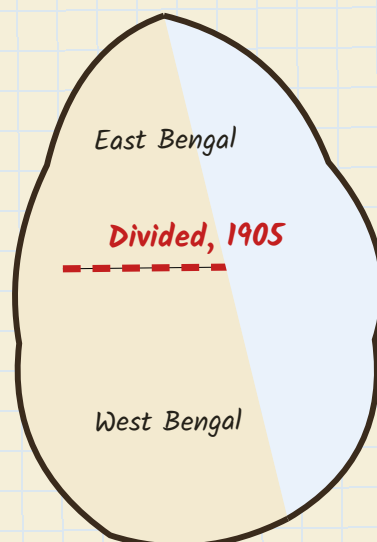
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LORD CURZON (1899-1905)

- **Partition of Bengal, 1905** — his most well-known and controversial act.
- **Indian Universities Act** — aimed at curbing anti-British activities among university youth.
- **Kolkata Corporation Act.**
- **Curzon-Kitchener controversy** — Lord Kitchener (commander of the British Army in India) argued that army matters should be resolved by the army itself, not the Viceroy.
- **Younghusband Mission** sent to **Tibet** — to prevent feared Russian influence/attack on India through that route.
- His tenure ended in **1905**, right after the Partition of Bengal.

Fig 4: Partition of Bengal, 1905



Exam Tip

Curzon's 5 big things: **Partition of Bengal (1905)**, **Indian Universities Act**, **Kolkata Corporation Act**, **Curzon-Kitchener controversy**, **Younghusband Mission to Tibet**.

Common Mistake

Don't mix up the **Curzon-Kitchener controversy** (about army control) with the **Partition of Bengal** (about administrative division) — two completely separate issues from the same tenure.

Memory Trick

"Curzon" sounds like "cursed" — remember him as the Viceroy people still "curse" (criticize) for the divisive Partition of Bengal.

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LORD MINTO II (1905-1910)

The **Muslim League** was formed during his tenure, in **1906**, in **Dhaka**. Founders: the **Aga Khan** and **Nawab Salimullah**.

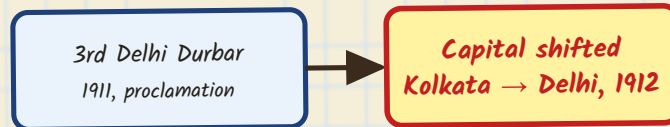
LORD HARDINGE II (1910-1916)

- **Third Delhi Durbar** organized during his time (the second had been held in 1903).
- Held for the coronation of **King George V**.
- At this Durbar, it was announced that India's capital would shift from **Kolkata** to **Delhi**.
- The proclamation was made in **1911**; the capital was officially shifted in **1912**.
- Reason given for the capital shift: to **appease Muslims**.

Delhi Durbar	Year	Viceroy	Occasion

1st	1877	Lytton	Queen Victoria's coronation
2nd	1903	—	—
3rd	1911	Hardinge II	King George V's coronation

 Fig 5: Capital Shifts to Delhi



 Exam Tip

Minto II → Muslim League (1906, Dhaka); Hardinge II → 3rd Delhi Durbar (1911) + Capital shift to Delhi (1912).

 Common Mistake

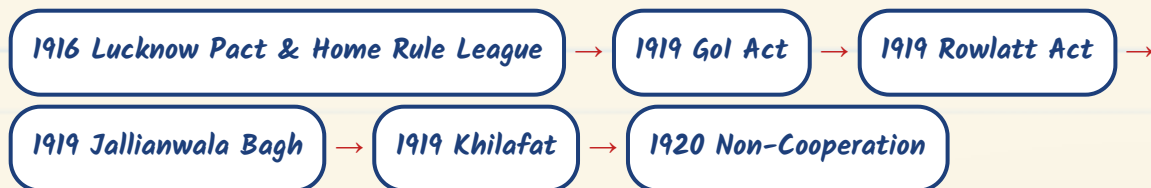
Don't confuse the year of the **proclamation** (1911, at the Delhi Durbar) with the year the capital **actually shifted** (1912) — they're one year apart!

 Memory Trick

Remember the order: **Curzon** → **Minto II** → **Hardinge II** — "C-M-H." Minto II gives you the Muslim League; Hardinge II gives you the Capital shift.

 LORD CHELMSFORD (1916-1921)

- **Lucknow Pact, 1916** — joint demands presented to the British by the **Indian National Congress and the Muslim League**; extremists were re-admitted into Congress (reunion of moderates and extremists); presided over by **Ambika Charan Majumdar**.
- **Home Rule League, 1916** — formed by **Annie Besant and Bal Gangadhar Tilak** (Tilak died in 1920).
- **Government of India Act, 1919** — also known as the **Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms**, named after Edwin Montagu (Secretary of State for India) and Lord Chelmsford (Viceroy).
- **Rowlatt Act, 1919** — allowed imprisonment without trial, appeal, or lawyer, for up to two years; Gandhiji called it the **"Black Act."**
- **Rowlatt Satyagraha** launched by Gandhiji; **Saifuddin Kitchlew and Dr. Satyapal** were arrested (April 1919).
- **Jallianwala Bagh massacre, 13 April 1919** — occurred during Baisakhi, while people protested the arrests.
- **Khilafat Movement** began, 1919.
- **Non-Cooperation Movement** launched, 1920.



Quick Note

The post of **Secretary of State for India** was created by the **Government of India Act, 1858**. Montagu held this post when the 1919 Act was passed — hence "Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms."

Exam Tip

Chelmsford's tenure (1916–1921) is packed: **Lucknow Pact + Home Rule League (1916)** → **Gol Act 1919** → **Rowlatt Act 1919** → **Jallianwala Bagh 1919** → **Khilafat 1919** → **Non-Cooperation 1920**.

Common Mistake

Don't confuse the **Rowlatt Act (1919, repressive law, no trial)** with the **Government of India Act 1919 (Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms, expanding self-government)** — both

passed the same year, for opposite purposes!



Memory Trick

Just like the **Morley-Minto Reforms** were named after Secretary of State Morley and Viceroy Minto, the **Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms** are named after Secretary of State Montagu and Viceroy Chelmsford.

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LORD READING (1921-1926)

- **Chauri Chaura incident, 1922.**
- Gandhiji withdrew the Non-Cooperation Movement in 1922 following Chauri Chaura.
- Gandhiji returned the title of "Kaiser-e-Hind" in protest.
- Rabindranath Tagore had earlier given up his knighthood after the Jallianwala Bagh massacre.
- A Hunter Commission reviewed the Jallianwala Bagh massacre; it held General R.E.H. Dyer responsible but prescribed no punishment for him.
- After the withdrawal of the Non-Cooperation Movement, Congress split into "pro-changers" and "no-changers."
- The pro-changers formed the **Swaraj Party**, known as the All India Khilafat Swaraj Party.
- **Kanpur (Bolshevik) Conspiracy Case, 1924.**
- The **Communist Party of India (CPI)** was formed in Tashkent, Uzbekistan in 1920 by M.N. Roy, and formally organized at an all-India conference in Kanpur in 1925.
- **Kakori train robbery, 1925.**
- **Hindustan Republican Association (HRA)** formed, 1924.



Fig 6: After the Non-Cooperation Movement

1922: Chauri Chaura → NCM withdrawn

Congress splits

Pro-changers
→ Swaraj Party

No-changers
continue as before

Don't Mix Up

Two Hunter Commissions exist: one on **Education** (Ripon's time) and one on the **Jallianwala Bagh massacre** (Reading's time, held Dyer responsible but no punishment)!

Exam Tip

1924 → HRA formed + Kanpur Conspiracy Case; 1925 → CPI formalized in Kanpur + Kakori train robbery — remember it year-wise.

Common Mistake

Don't think Gandhiji withdrew the Non-Cooperation Movement out of exhaustion — it was specifically due to the **violence at Chauri Chaura in 1922**.

Memory Trick

"Pro-changers" (wanted to change strategy, formed the Swaraj Party) vs "no-changers" (wanted to continue as before) — the **names literally tell you their stance!**

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LORD IRWIN (1926-1931)

- **Simon Commission** arrived in India, 1928.

- **Lala Lajpat Rai** died during protests against the **Simon Commission**.
- **John Saunders** was assassinated in revenge, by **Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and Rajguru**, 1928.
- **Lahore Session of Congress**, 1929.
- **First Round Table Conference**, 1930.
- **Gandhi-Irwin Pact**, 1931.
- **Second Round Table Conference** began in 1931 — the **only RTC in which Gandhiji/Congress participated** (its proceedings extended into Willingdon's tenure).

LORD WILLINGDON (1931-1936)

- **Second Round Table Conference** concluded (Gandhiji and Congress participated).
- **Communal Award** announced by **Ramsay MacDonald** — granted separate electorates to the Dalits (Depressed Classes).
- Gandhiji went on a **fast unto death** in protest of the **Communal Award**.
- **Poona Pact** signed between **Gandhiji and Ambedkar** as a result.
- **Government of India Act, 1935** came into force — called for an **All India Federation** (never materialized) and a **Federal Court** (established 1937, later replaced by the Supreme Court of India).
- **All India Kisan Sabha** formed, 1936, by **Sahajanand Saraswati**.
- **Congress Socialist Party** formed, 1934, by **Acharya Narendra Dev, Minoo Masani, and Jayaprakash Narayan** (formed after the Lucknow session of Congress).

1928 Simon Commission →

1929 Lahore Session →

1930 1st RTC →

1931 Gandhi-Irwin Pact →

1931 2nd RTC →

Communal Award →

Poona Pact →

1935 Gov Act

Exam Tip

Only the **Second Round Table Conference (1931)** had Gandhiji/Congress participation — the First (1930) did not!

Common Mistake

Don't confuse the **Communal Award** (separate electorates for Dalits, opposed by Gandhiji) with the **Poona Pact** (the compromise reached afterward between Gandhiji and Ambedkar).



Memory Trick

Both key 1931 events span two Viceroy's: the **Gandhi-Irwin Pact and First RTC** closed under Irwin, while the **Second RTC** (same year, later months) carried into Willingdon's tenure — simple logic: if both happened in 1931, the second one must be near year-end, under the new Viceroy.

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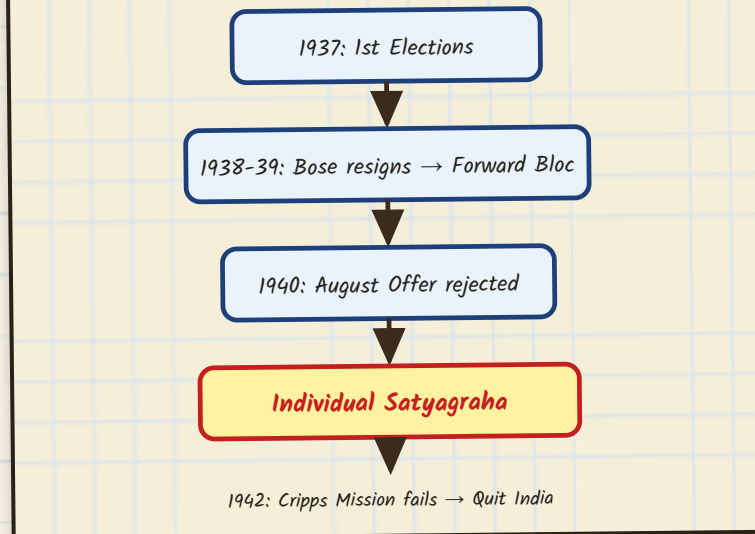
LORD LINLITHGOW (1936-1944)

An **8-year tenure** — the longest of all the Viceroy's studied so far.

- **First General Elections** held, 1937 (as provided for under the Government of India Act, 1935).
- **Haripura Session** of Congress, 1938; **Tripuri Session**, 1939 — after which **Subhash Chandra Bose** resigned from Congress.
- Bose formed the **All India Forward Bloc**, 1939, within the Congress.
- **National Planning Committee** formed, 1938, by Subhash Chandra Bose; its first head was **Jawaharlal Nehru**.
- **August Offer**, 1940 — rejected by Congress.
- **Individual Satyagraha** launched in response; **Acharya Vinoba Bhave** was the first Individual Satyagrahi, **Jawaharlal Nehru** the second.
- **Cripps Mission** arrived in India, 1942.
- **Quit India Movement** launched in response to the failure of the Cripps Mission, 1942.
- Gandhiji gave the slogan "**Do or Die**" during the Quit India Movement.



 Fig 7: Linlithgow's Timeline (1936–1944)



 Remember

Linlithgow's tenure is **8 years**, not the usual 5 — easy to mix him up with a 5-year Viceroy if you forget this!

 Exam Tip

Cause-and-effect chain: **August Offer rejected** → **Individual Satyagraha**; **Cripps Mission fails** → **Quit India Movement**.

 Common Mistake

Don't confuse the **National Planning Committee** (1938, formed by Bose, headed by Nehru) with the **All India Forward Bloc** (1939, formed by Bose after leaving the Congress presidency) — two different bodies, one year apart.

 Memory Trick

Bose resigned after the **Tripuri Session (1939)** and formed the Forward Bloc that same year — "Tripuri to Trouble" (he left Congress and started his own bloc).

LORD WAVELL (1944-1947)

- Wavell Plan proposed, 1945.
- Shimla Conference held, 1945 — prisoners jailed during the Quit India Movement were released and called to Shimla to discuss the plan.
- Cabinet Mission Plan came to India, 1946.
- Jinnah announced Direct Action Day, 16 August 1946 — led to widespread riots and violence.



Aside — Vinoba Bhave

Acharya Vinoba Bhave, associated with the Bhoodan Movement (started 1951, from Pochampalli, Telangana), received the first Ramon Magsaysay Award in 1958.

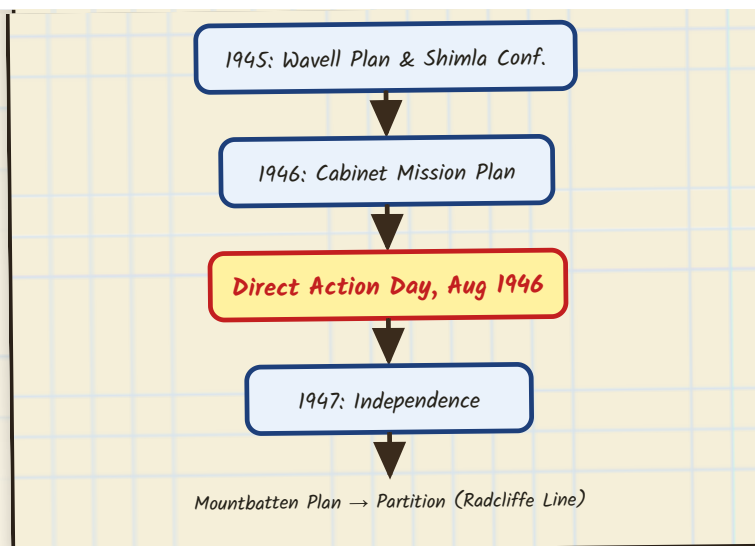
LORD MOUNTBATTEN (1947-1948)

- Last Viceroy of India (1947-1948).
- Brought the Mountbatten Plan, also known as the Partition Plan.
- The Boundary Commission, headed by Sir Cyril Radcliffe, demarcated the boundary between India and Pakistan (the same line today also separates India and Bangladesh).
- After independence in 1947, Mountbatten was retained, out of respect, as the first Governor General of independent India.
- C. Rajagopalachari succeeded him as the first, last, and only Indian to become Governor General of India.



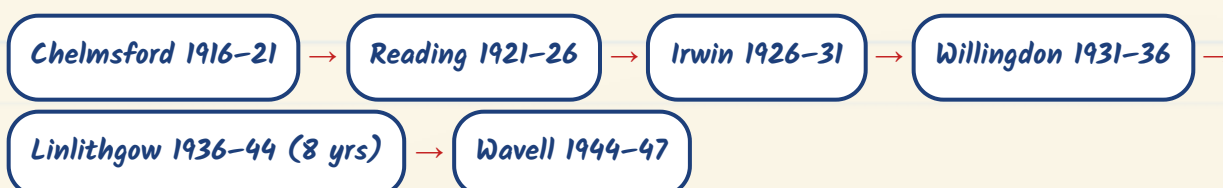
Fig 8: The Road to Independence & Partition





Memory Trick – Remembering the Viceroy Order

Imagine reading in a Ford car – that's Reading (1921–26), following Chelmsford (1916–21). While reading, you drift into a dream where Lakshya Sen wins – that covers Irwin's era (1926–31), another 5 years added on. Then a "Don" (a Malaysian Don) arrives and says "go now" – sounds like "Willingdon" (1931–36), because his "wave" is coming. Then comes Linlithgow (1936–44) – but this one lasts 8 years, not 5. Finally, Wavell (1944–47) – his very name sounds like "wave," closing the wave-themed chain right before independence.



Full Recap – Viceroy of India

- 1858–62 — Canning (1st Viceroy)
- 1876–80 — Lytton
- 1880–84 — Ripon
- 1899–1905 — Curzon
- 1905–10 — Minto II
- 1910–16 — Hardinge II

- 1916-21 — Chelmsford
- 1921-26 — Reading
- 1926-31 — Irwin
- 1931-36 — Willingdon
- 1936-44 — Linlithgow
- 1944-47 — Wavell
- 1947-48 — Mountbatten (last Viceroy)

C. Rajagopalachari — first, last & only Indian Governor General of India!

Exam Tip

Order to memorize: **Canning** → **Lawrence** → **Mayo** → **Lytton** → **Ripon** → **Dufferin** → **Curzon** → **Minto II** → **Hardinge II** → **Chelmsford** → **Reading** → **Irwin** → **Willingdon** → **Linlithgow** → **Wavell** → **Mountbatten**.

Common Mistake

Don't confuse **Governor General of India** (title before 1858, and briefly again for Mountbatten/Rajagopalachari after 1947) with **Viceroy** (title used 1858-1947, under Crown Rule).

Memory Trick

Wavell = "wave will" (come) — his name is the mnemonic's punchline: the "wave" the joke built up to, right before independence arrived in 1947!